

THE WHITE HOUSE

WASHINGTON

POLICY MEMORANDUM

DATE: March 23rd, 2026

FROM: Megan Fife

SOURCES: [Homeland Security Today US](#), [Field Effect](#), [Irregular Warfare](#), [U.S. Department of Justice](#), [Industrial Cyber](#)

TOPIC: Cyber Spillover Risks to U.S. Critical Infrastructure

ISSUE: Whether recent cyber incidents indicate a need for stronger U.S. defensive or deterrent measures to protect critical infrastructure. The narrative is that cyber weapons are easy to use, cheap to manufacture and effective in attacks.

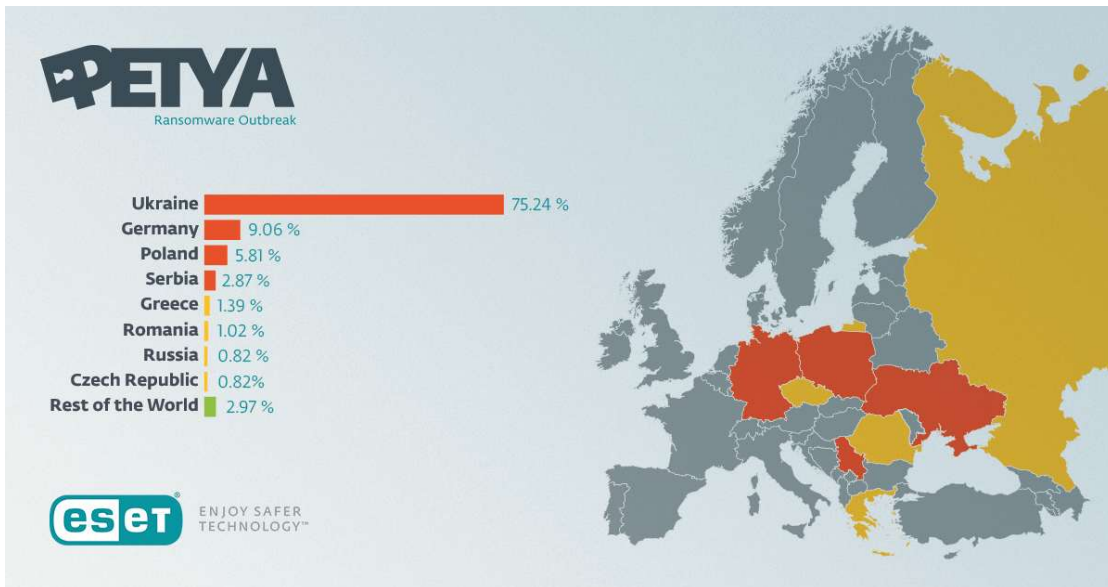
BACKGROUND: Cyber spillovers happen when a cyber-attack goes beyond the original targets to harm other countries, individuals or even yourself. On March 7, President Trump's Cyber Strategy for America was released with six pillars. U.K. National Cyber Security Centre (NCSC) warned of cyber spillover risk for Western agencies allied with U.S. and Israel. Handala Hack from Iranian group, this month using malware against U.S.-based multinational medical technologies firm to steal documents from the Sanzer Hasidic Jewish community. Iran not as advanced as China and Russia. 3 out of 24 major cyber spillovers since 1998 have had more than \$800 million in losses (total \$40 billion); Yaha (India, 2002-3, \$20 billion), WannaCry (North Korea, 2017, \$10 billion), and NotPetya (Russia military, 2017 \$10 billion). NotPetya against Ukraine which affected NATO countries and Russia as well, had the biggest cyber spillover but economic effect world absorbed, and outcome Russia-Ukraine war.

OPTIONS:

1. Reduce U.S. dependency on cyber capable regions, Middle East, Russia, China.
Action: Incentivize businesses to leave region or move data centers, clouds away.
Pros: Government supporting private companies, lessens economic impact.
Cons: Restructures businesses, costly, outcome effectiveness unclear, untested.
2. Enforce more online security measures for employees, make infrastructure stronger.
Action: Increase online training, awareness, and contingency plans.
Pros: More security for companies.
Cons: Government only controls own employees, already a lot of training.
3. Target specific online agencies, groups claiming attacks.
Action: Investigate online hackers and attacks, take legal action against.
Pros: Stops groups who have the capability to harm infrastructure.

Cons: Reactionary, effect based, not long-term solution.

RECOMMENDATION: That you approve Option 1. Reduce U.S. business dependency on cyber capable regions is best for U.S. national security. However, we should be getting ahead of this risk and research cutting edge technological solutions to prevent cyber spillover risk to infrastructure.



NotPetya, Number of Ransomware Attacks per Country - [We Live Security](#)

THIS WEBSITE HAS BEEN SEIZED

This domain has been seized by the Federal Bureau of Investigation ("FBI") pursuant to a seizure warrant issued by a United States District Court for the District of Maryland as part of a law enforcement action by the FBI. Law enforcement authorities determined this domain was used to conduct, facilitate, or support malicious cyber activities on behalf of, or in coordination with, a foreign state actor. These activities may include unauthorized network intrusions, infrastructure targeting, or other violations of United States law. Pursuant to the court-authorized warrant, the United States Government has taken control of this domain to disrupt ongoing malicious cyber operations and prevent further exploitation.



The services or infrastructure previously accessible through this domain are no longer available. Individuals or entities who knowingly participate in, assist with, or attempt to restore infrastructure used in support of foreign state-sponsored cyber operations may be subject to criminal prosecution, sanctions, or other legal action under applicable United States law, including statutes related to computer intrusion, fraud, and/or conspiracy and material support to hostile foreign operations.

This seizure is part of a continuing FBI operation to identify, disrupt, and hold accountable those responsible for hostile cyber activities directed against the United States, its institutions, and its partners.

Handala Hack FBI Resposne - [Security Week](#)